Visual Identity Guidelines
July 2017

blue meridian partners

Introduction

Every organization's visual identity is the collective result of each piece of branding that is exposed to the viewer. These pieces include printed materials, stationery, web applications, apparel, and so on.

When an organization’s effort is a coordinated one, a unified character is established with the organization's audience. Over time that unified character can be reinforced until there is a deep connection between the organization and those it's trying to reach. In many cases, it also helps the organization to be more cost-effective by coordinating its communications efforts.

Creating a strong and lasting visual identity in a cost-effective way is especially important to Blue Meridian Partners. By minimizing extraneous, ineffective, or disparate communications, the organization is better positioned to maximize its philanthropic investments. Each dollar saved is one more that will be put towards making effective and lasting positive change.

This manual's purpose is to explain the core components of the Blue Meridian Partners visual identity program, to define its graphic design standards, and to specify how these standards are applied.

Many of these standards depend on relative size, proportion, and position. These have been developed through careful consideration of many factors, both functional and aesthetic. Adhering to these standards will ensure continuity, an exacting standard of quality, and a clear, consistent identity for all that are exposed to Blue Meridian Partners.

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1. The Logo

blue meridian
partners

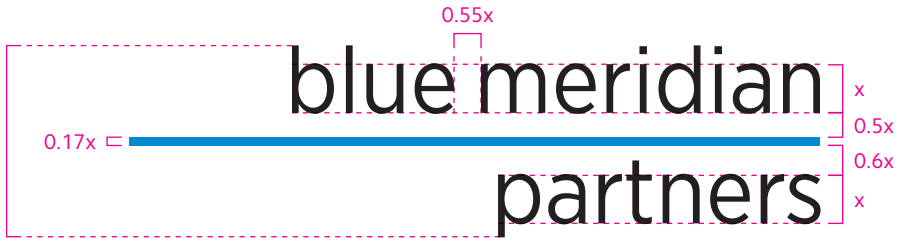
CMYK 77, 33, 0, 0
PMS 2173 U/C
RGB 0, 145, 200
WEB #0091C8

Blue Meridian blue

CMYK 100, 0, 0, 0
PMS Process Black U/C
RGB 0, 0, 0
WEB #000000

Type black

When the logo is measured vertically, it is done from ascenders on the top line to the descender on the bottom line



Logo construction

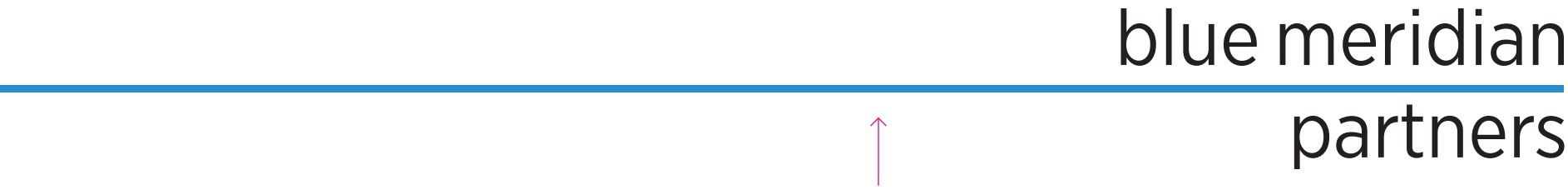
1.1 The Logo

The Blue Meridian Partners logo consists of the organization's name set in lowercase sans-serif typography split by a blue line which we will refer to as the "horizon line". The horizon line's length is dynamic and extends to the leftmost edge whenever possible (see the following page for more detail on this).

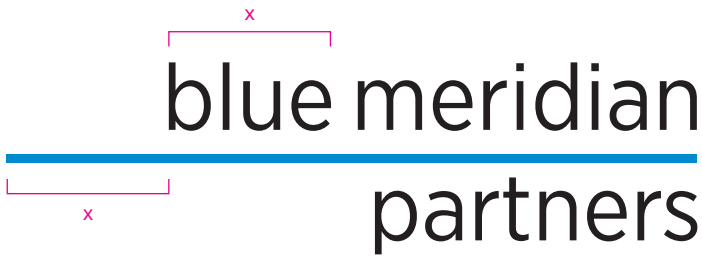
The letters used within the logo have been customized for Blue Meridian Partners, and the spacing between each letter has been carefully set. As such, it should not be reset using a standard font or redrawn in any way.

If a black and white version of the logo is required, the entire logo becomes black.

blue meridian
partners



Extend the horizon line to the left bleed of the application wherever possible.



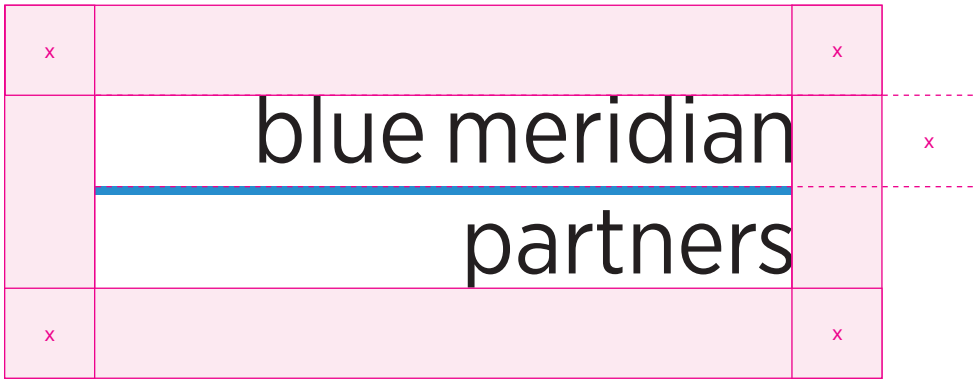
minimum width of the horizon line

1.2 The Horizon Line

Extending the horizon line
The horizon line should be extended to the left bleed of the application. This is a key feature of the Blue Meridian Partners' visual identity and should be executed wherever possible.

Where full-bleed printing is not possible, it is acceptable to extend the horizon line to the left print margin.

Minimum length
When extending the very left edge of the application is not appropriate, such as when the logo is used next to peer logos, the minimum-width version should be used. The horizon line is never to extend to the left of the typography less than the width of the word 'blue' as shown above.



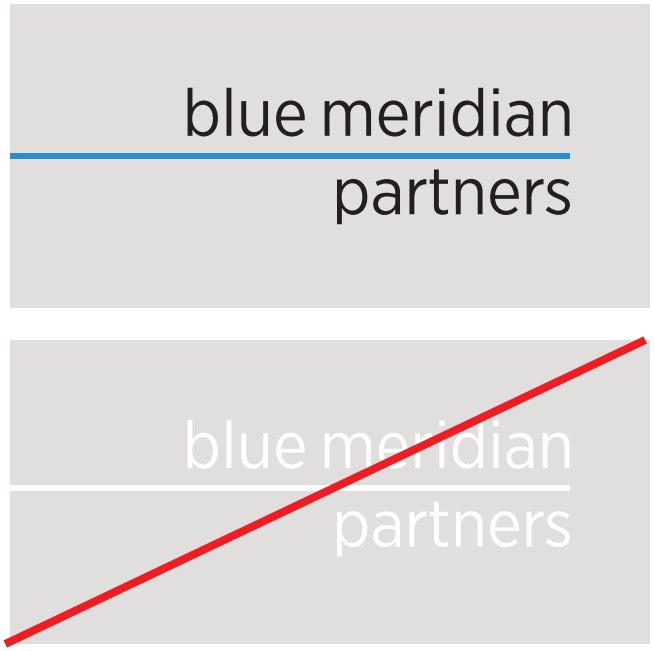
1.3 Clearspace and Minimum Size

Clearspace
For the logo to communicate effectively, the area surrounding it must remain clear of competing graphics or document edges.

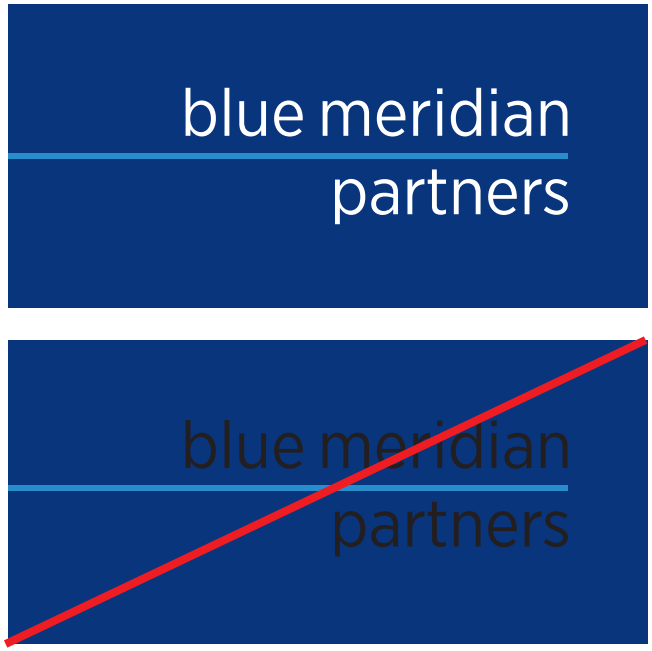
The clearspace of the Blue Meridian Partners logo is the equivalent of the distance from the ascenders in the top line of typography to the beginning of the horizon line.

In cases where the logo is bled to the left edge of the application the left side of the clearspace does not apply.

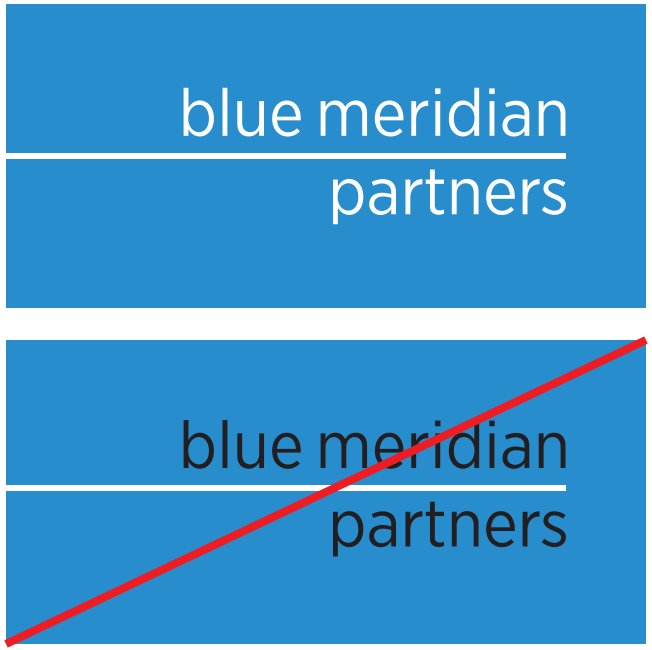
Minimum size
The logo should never be made smaller than ¼" tall in print applications or 25px tall in digital applications.



With sufficient contrast for both colors, use the standard logo



With insufficient contrast for the black, make the type white



With insufficient contrast for the blue, make the whole logo white

1.4 Logo on Color

The preferred color combination for the logo is black type with a blue horizon line over a white background. In cases where the logo is used over a color other than white, however, care must be taken when considering the amount of contrast given.

If both the black and blue can be clearly seen, then the original logo should be used, which is ideal.

If the black cannot be clearly seen but the blue can, the logo's type should be changed to white with the line remaining blue.

If the blue cannot be clearly seen, even if the black can be, an all-white logo should be used. Never use a white line with black text. The all-white configuation should be used sparingly, as it loses the blue horizon line, which is a key feature of the visual identity.

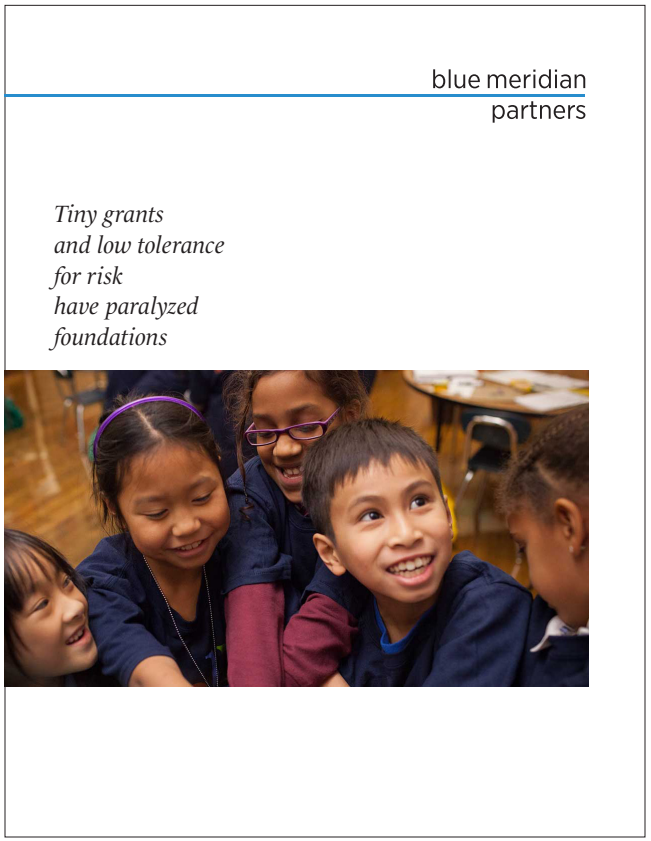
Using overlays is an effective way to reduce contrast and busyness to aid the logo's legibility

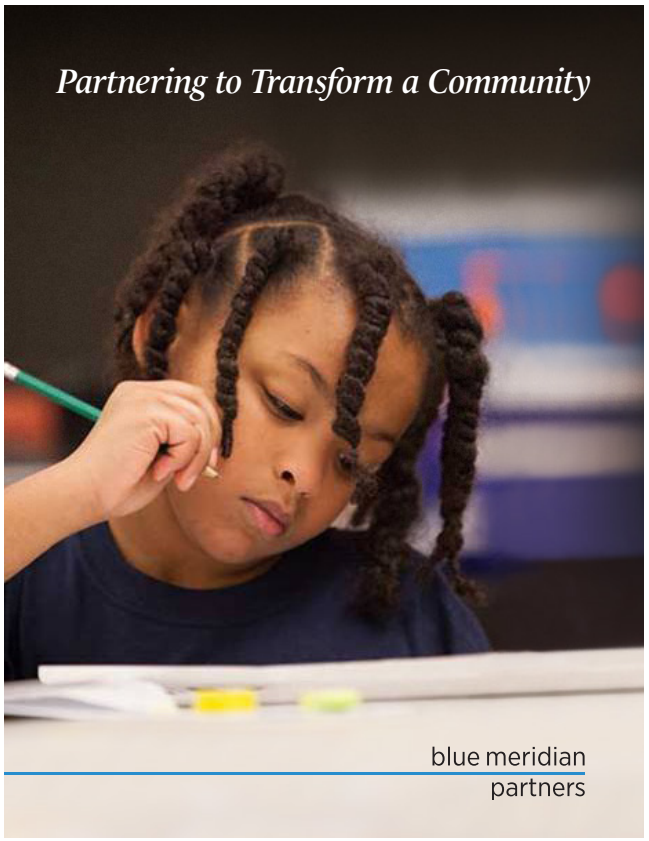
When there is not enough contrast for the horizon line, the entire logo is made white

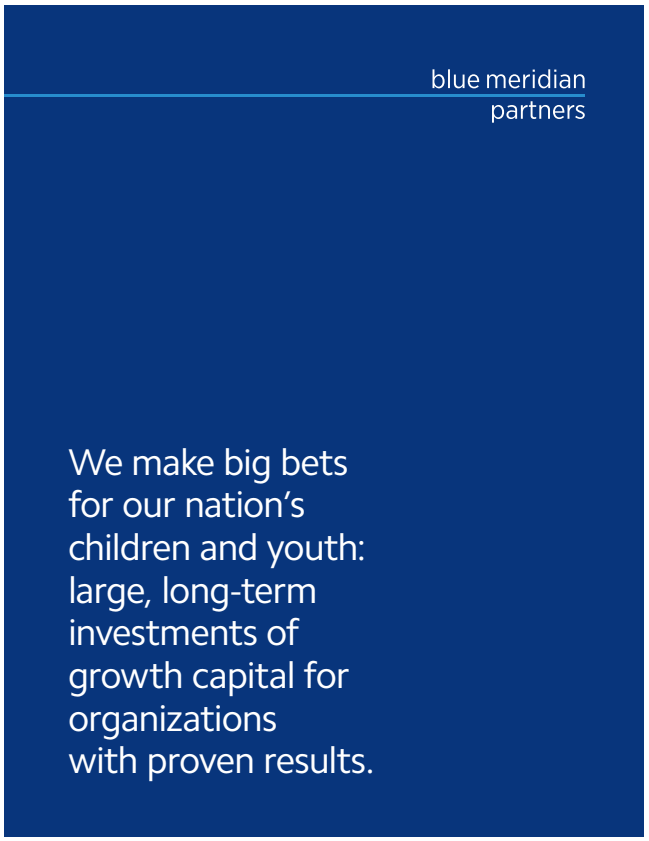
When the logo is placed over a very dark area, the typography is made white

1.5 Logo on Photography

It is important to ensure that the area of a photograph the logo is placed in provides sufficient contrast for the logo and is free of busy elements. In order to ensure this, you may need to manipulate the photograph or use an alternate color combination for the logo as per the previous page.







1.6 Logo and Font on Print Publications

The position and alignment of the logo will largely depend on what works best with the given layout. It is important to be sure that the horizon line extends the maximum amount to the left, as shown.

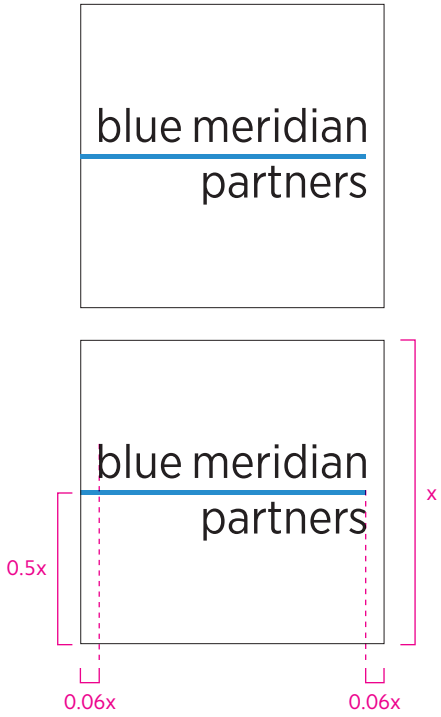
On the brochure examples shown above, note that either the Le Monde Livre or Camphor fonts have been used for the title or large text, and that the Blue Meridian Partners logo is used prominently, with generous space around it.

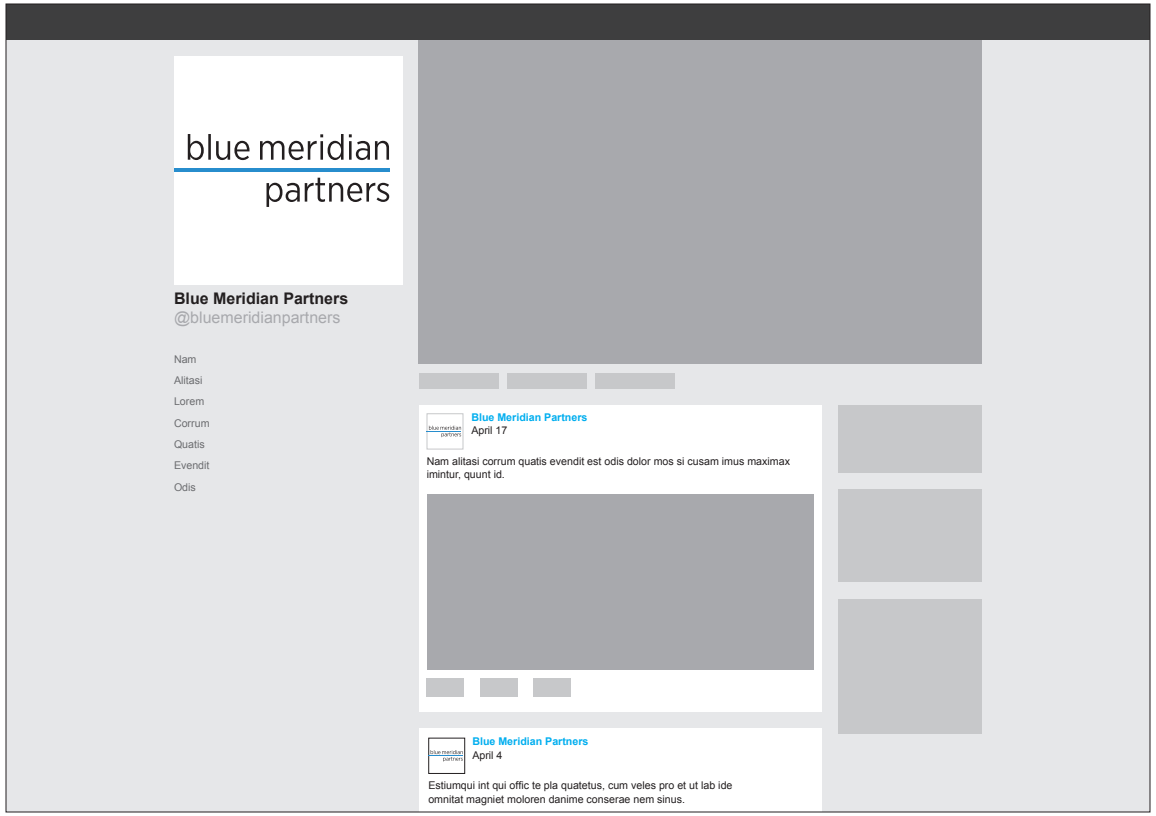
1.7 Logo Use with Peer Logos

When the Blue Meridian Partners logo is used in concert with peer logos, the minimum length version should be used (see page 1.2 for details).

The Blue Meridian Partners logo should be sized so that it does not appear smaller than those of its peers. This should be done by sizing the logos optically rather than mechanically. This allows the logos to feel on equal ground with one another, even if they are not the same mathematical height or width.

Alignment should be done optically rather than mechanically whenever possible as well.



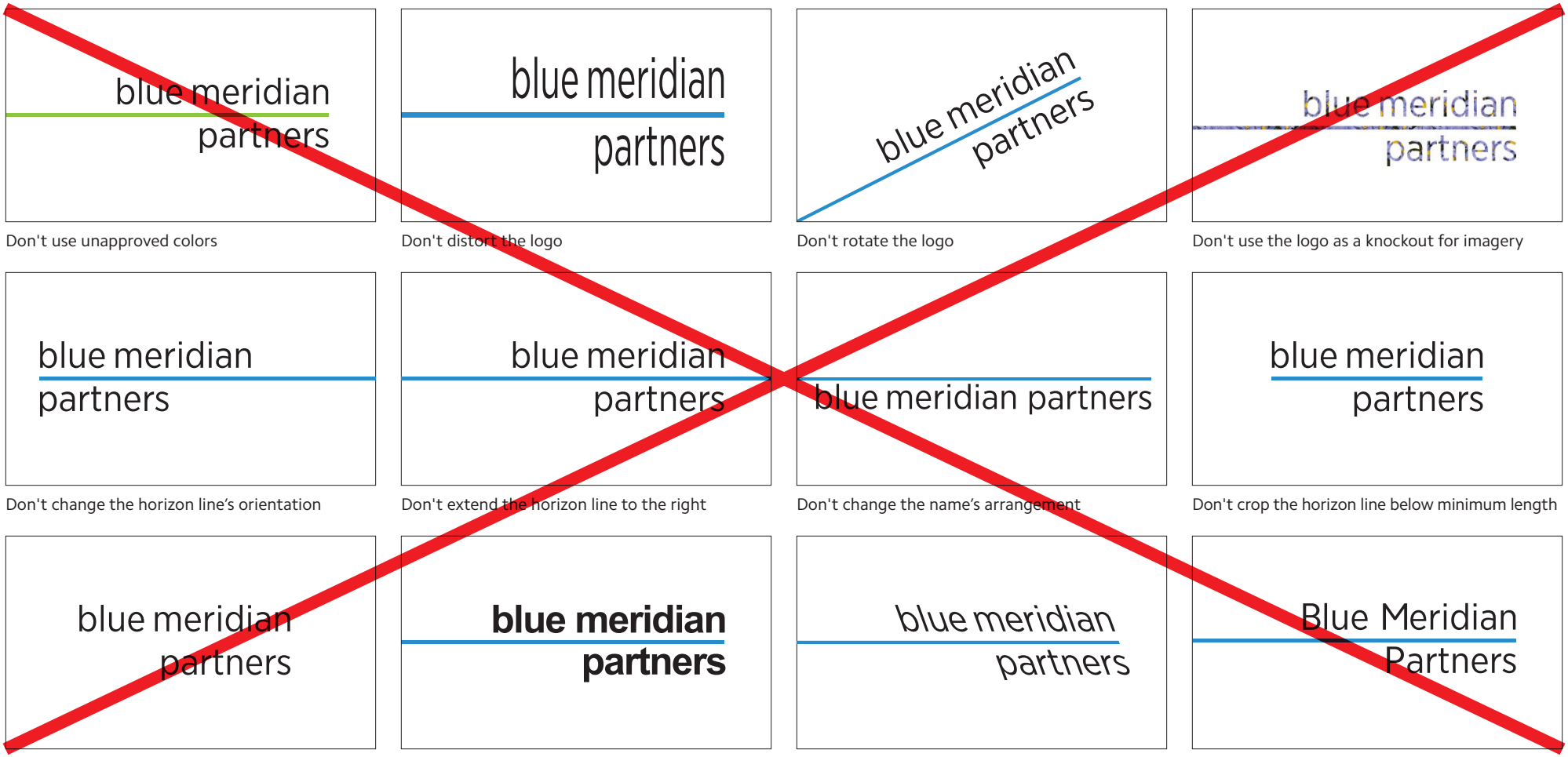


The reduced horizon line helps legibility at extremely small sizes

1.8 Logo on Digital Publications

When the logo is needed to be used at very small digital sizes, such as for social media avatars, a special configuration has been developed to maximize legibility.

This version frames the logo more tightly on the left and right than you would otherwise see in order to increase the organization name's legibility in social media feeds.



Don't use unapproved colors

Don't distort the logo

Don't rotate the logo

Don't use the logo as a knockout for imagery

Don't change the horizon line's orientation

Don't extend the horizon line to the right

Don't change the name's arrangement

Don't crop the horizon line below minimum length

Don't remove the horizon line

Don't modify the typography

Don't change the perspective of the logo

Don't change the name's casing style

1.9 Incorrect Logo Use

Modifying the logo in an unauthorized fashion will fracture and harm the Blue Meridian Partners visual identity. Above are just a few examples of what not to do.

If you don't see a treatment of the logo covered in this book, then it is highly likely it should not be done.

2. Color, Type, and Photography

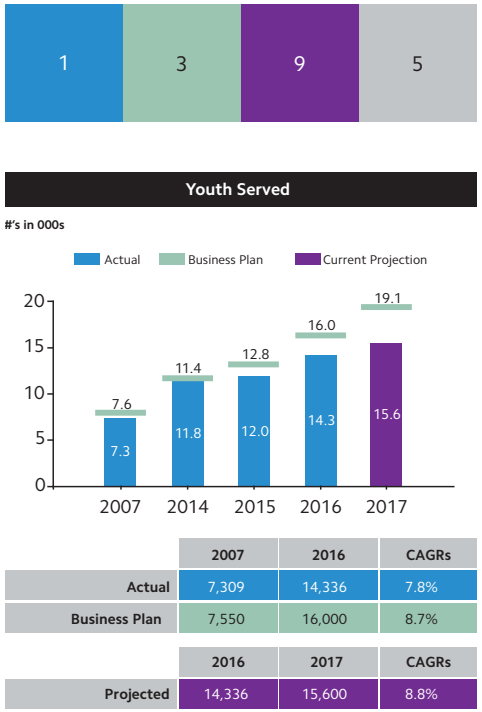
1 **CMYK** 77, 33, 0, 0 **PMS** 2173 U/C **RGB** 0, 145, 200 **WEB** #0091C8	**2** **CMYK** 40, 18, 9, 0 **PMS** 651 U/C **RGB** 150, 185, 210 **WEB** #96B9D2	**3** **CMYK** 35, 3, 30, 8 **PMS** 5513 U/C **RGB** 160, 190, 175 **WEB** #A0BEAF	**4** **CMYK** 5, 22, 80, 10 **PMS** 110 U/C **RGB** 205, 160, 80 **WEB** #CDA050	**5** **CMYK** 10, 7, 7, 16 **PMS** Cool Gray 4 **RGB** 195, 195, 200 **WEB** #C3C3C8	**6** **CMYK** 0, 50, 100, 0 **PMS** 144 U/C **RGB** 240, 140, 0 **WEB** #F08C00
	7 **CMYK** 100, 80, 0, 30 **PMS** 661 U/C **RGB** 0, 40, 130 **WEB** #002882	**8** **CMYK** 90, 0, 100, 0 **PMS** 355 U/C **RGB** 0, 150, 55 **WEB** #009637	**9** **CMYK** 69, 99, 0, 0 **PMS** 526 U/C **RGB** 120, 60, 150 **WEB** #783C96	**10** **CMYK** 58, 32, 18, 54 **PMS** 7545 U/C **RGB** 60, 80, 100 **WEB** #3C5064	**11** **CMYK** 0, 95, 94, 28 **PMS** 7620 U/C **RGB** 180, 50, 45 **WEB** #B4322D

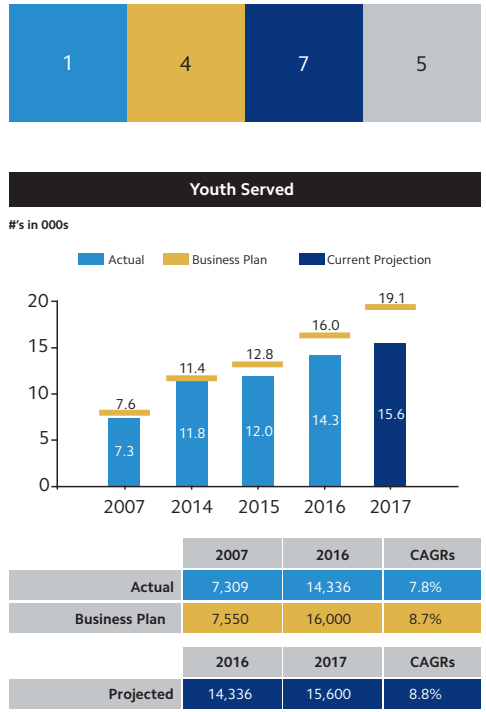
2.1 Color Palette

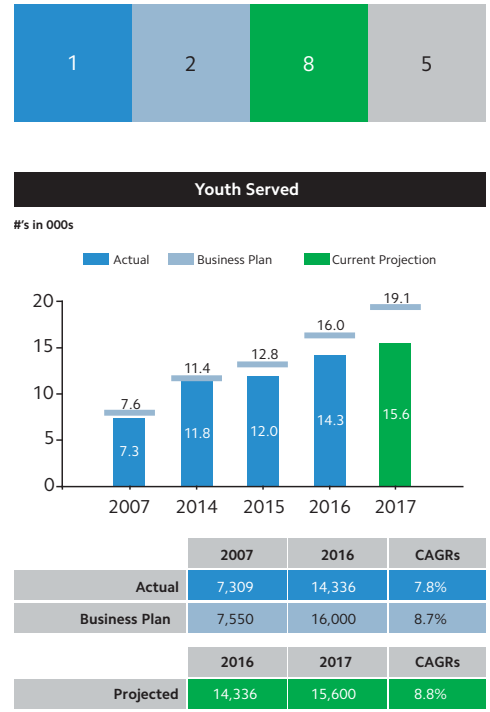
This range of colors has been developed for use individually or in concert with one another to help estabish a cohesive visual identity. The palette is made up of eleven colors, which includes the blue used for the horizon line.

While the red and orange colors (6 and 11) are intended as accent colors, and will be used less often than the others, there is no strict order of use for the color palette. In order to make color selection simpler, several color groups have been selected, which you can see on the following page. The numbers 1–11 shown above the color values are for reference only.

Each color has been assigned CMYK, RGB, and PMS (Pantone Matching System®) values in order to cover the majority of likely applications. If another color system's use is needed, match as closely as possible to the listed PMS values.







2.2 Color Groups

In order to make selecting colors easier, three groups of four colors each have been defined.

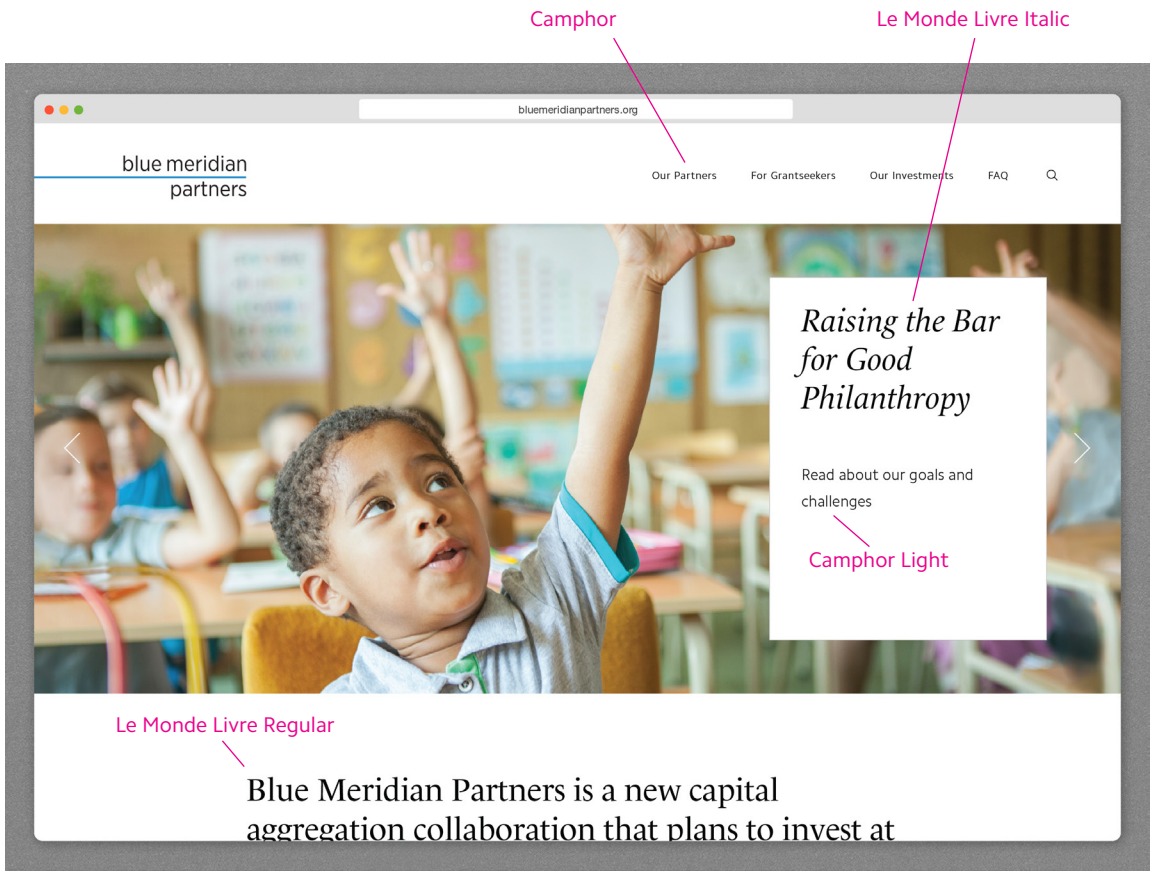
Each group includes the Blue Meridian blue (1) and light gray (5). Two of the four colors are unique to each of the groups. This allows them to be both distinct from one another while still feeling familiar when multiple of these groups are used within the same report or presentation.

The values for each color can be found on the previous page.

Here is a Title Set in Le Monde Livre Italic 20/24pt

Here is some body copy set in Camphor Regular 10/12pt. Onsequod et duciandam dollecum facepudam vernam ad quundis alite quia intur alitatatecum facillest, elignatempel id.

Nestia volorem porporp oraturesto ipsam voluptat. Ugiatiae adit est, temporum, omnisque consequasped mo comnia dolum solorup taquam volorumqui con ex es il et.



A website is one example where both typefaces could be used in concert with one another

2.3 Typography Overview

Two type families have been selected as part of Blue Meridian Partners' visual identity. Le Monde Livre is a serif typeface, which will be used mainly for headlines and titles. Camphor is a sans-serif typeface, which will usually be used for body copy and other small text, though it can also be used for headlines and sub-heads.

Italic styles may be used as the default style for headlines, but it is not required. Italics and bolds may be used to emphasize information as is appropriate within body copy and small text.

The size of both headline and body copy should be determined based on the individual application, taking into consideration things such as size of the text area, amount of text, and desired impact. Body copy should be set in a size that does not result in an overly-long measure (number of characters for each line) in order to assist legibility.

Camphor

Camphor Regular

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890 ?!$~@#%^&().

Camphor Italic

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890 ?!$~@#%^&().

Camphor Bold

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890 ?!$~@#%^&().

Camphor Bold Italic

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890 ?!$~@#%^&().

An example of Camphor in use

2.4 Sans-serif Typography

Camphor is a sans-serif typeface designed by Nick Job, which was released in 2010. It has many weights with matching italics, which can be used to set dense body copy at small sizes while remaining legible and pleasant to read. Regular and bold are the recommended weights for typical use. It is available for both print and web applications.

Le Monde Livre

Le Monde Livre Regular

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890 ?!$~@#%^&().

Le Monde Livre Italic

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890 ?!$~@#%^&().

Le Monde Livre Demi

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890 ?!$~@#%^&().

Le Monde Livre Demi Italic

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890 ?!$~@#%^&().

An example of Le Monde Livre in use

2.5 Serif Typography

Le Monde Livre is a serif typeface designed by Jean François Porchez, which was released in 1997. It has many weights with matching italics, which can be used to set headlines and titles. Regular and demi are the recommended weights for typical use. It is available for both print and web applications.

Calibri

Calibri Regular

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890 ?!$~@#%^&().

Calibri Bold

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890 ?!$~@#%^&().

Times New Roman

Times New Roman Regular

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890 ?!$~@#%^&().

Times New Roman Bold

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890 ?!$~@#%^&().

2.6 Alternative System Fonts

If Camphor or Le Monde Livre are not available on your computer, or if a system font is required such as in email design, cross-platform system fonts have been chosen as fallbacks.

For sans-serif typography, use Calibri. For serif typography, use Times New Roman.

These fonts should only be used when it is absolutely necessary.

Do use photography that prominently features people

Do use photo that feels natural in lighting and composition

Don't use photos that feel forced or posed

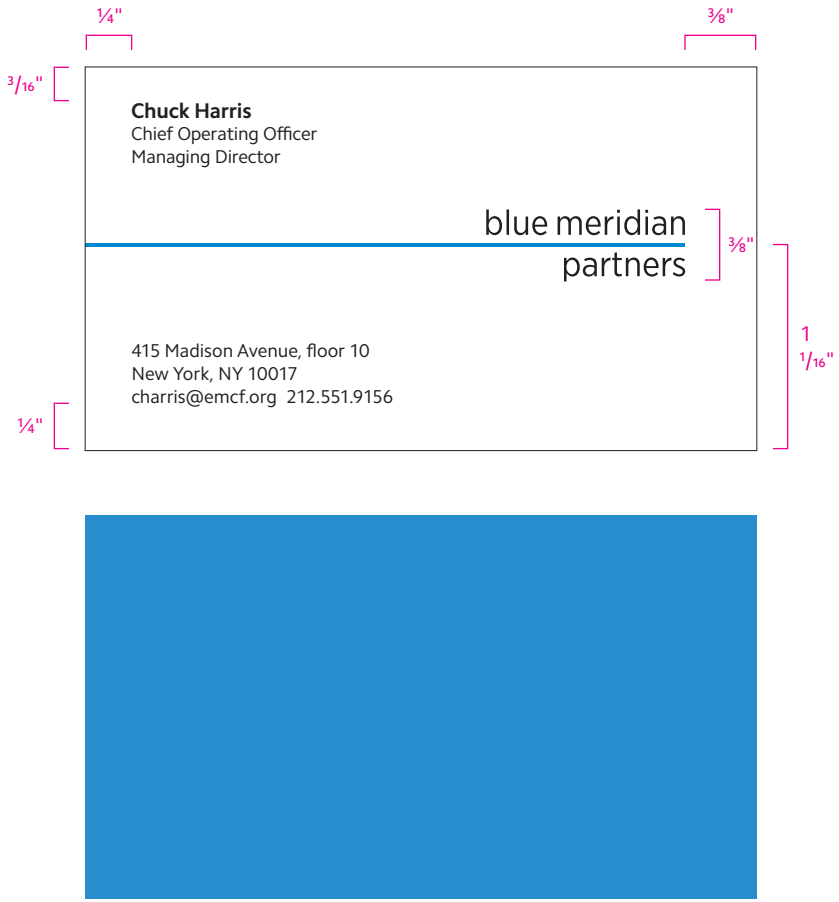
2.7 Photography Overview

When picking photography to be used for Blue Meridian Partners, it is important to make sure that it feels as natural as possible. High quality photography is important in setting a professional and trustworthy tone for Blue Meridian Partners.

Photography featuring people is preferred over that which showcases inanimate objects or natural environments. Photography should always honor the subject's humanity and center on them as key actors rather than relying on stereotypes or subjugation.

Full-color photography is strongly preferred over black and white, as it feels more natural and lively.

3. Applications



3.1 Business Card

Size
3 ½ x 2"

Color
Front: offset PMS 2173 + Process Black logo and information

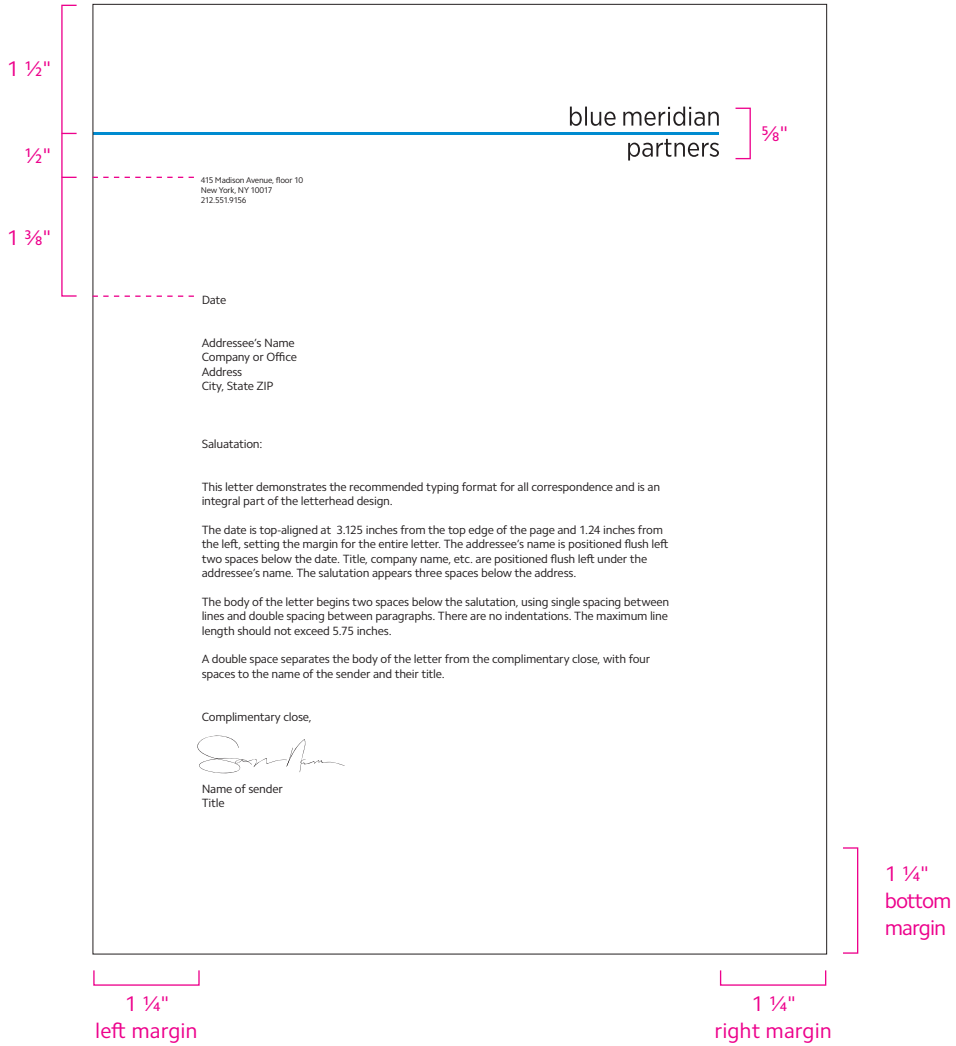
Back: offset PMS 2173

Paper
Neenah Classic Crest
130# Cover, Solar White
Smooth Finish

Typography
Name: Camphor Bold 8/8.5pt

Title: Camphor Regular 7/8.5pt

Typography (continued)
Address, email, and phone:
Camphor Regular 7/8.5pt



3.2 Letterhead

Size
8 ½ x 11"

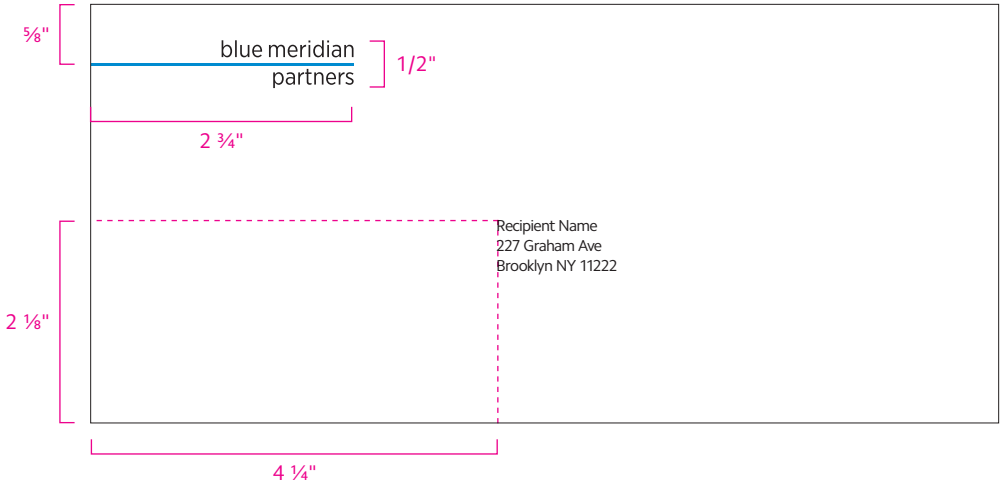
Color
Offset PMS 2173 + Process Black
pre-printed logo and address/phone

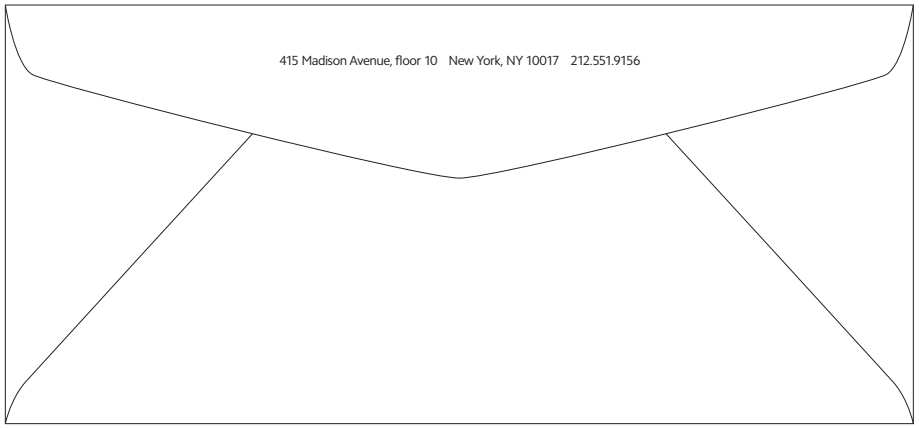
Process Black
post-printed letter

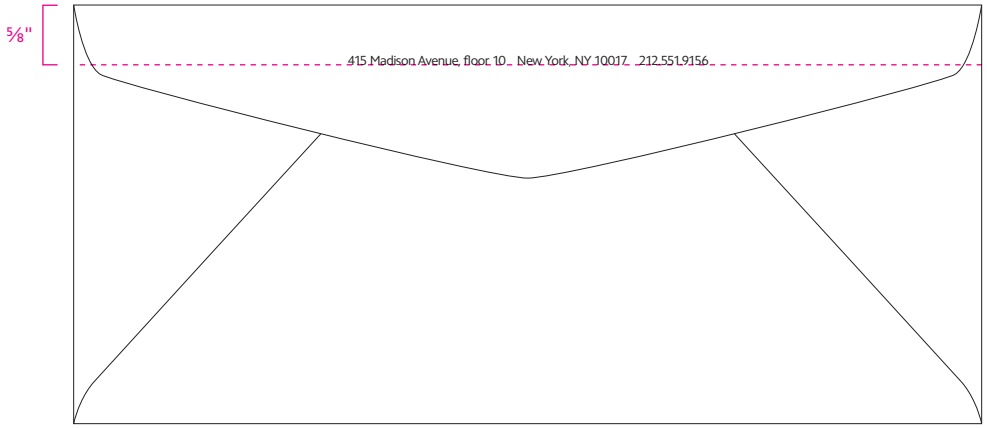
Paper
Neenah Classic Crest
80# Text, Solar White
Smooth Finish

Typography
Address, email, and phone:
Camphor Regular 7/8.5pt

Typography (continued)
Letter contents:
Camphor Regular 10/12pt







3.3 #10 Envelope

Size
9 ½ x 4 ⅛"

Color
Offset PMS 2173 + Process Black
pre-printed logo and return address

Process Black
post-printed recipient info

Paper
Neenah Classic Crest
80# Text, Solar White
Smooth Finish

Typography
Return address: Camphor Regular 7pt

Recipient info: Camphor Regular
12/15pt

Dear Charles,

It was a pleasure speaking with you about your organization and the impact it's having. We would be delighted to talk about how Blue Meridian Partners can partner with you in order to effect even greater change.

I am copying in Geraldine, Joaquin, and Sam so that we can find the best time to all get together next.

Sincerely,
Joan

Joan Boyden
Head of PR
Blue Meridian Partners

blue meridian
partners

415 Madison Avenue, floor 10
New York, NY 10017
212.531.9156

Salutation,

Calibri 14px is used for the body of the email. The email begins two spaces below the salutation, using single spacing between lines and double spacing between paragraphs. There are no indentations.

A double space separates the body of the email from the complimentary close, with another double space to the start of the signature.

Sincerely,
Name

Full Name
Full Title
Blue Meridian Partners

blue meridian
partners

55px

279px

415 Madison Avenue, floor 10
New York, NY 10017
212.531.9156

3.4 E-mail Signature

Color
Black (#000000)

Typography
Body copy and signature information: Calibri 14px

Full name: Calibri Bold 14px

The email signature should be set up to ensure that the image used for the Blue Meridian Partners logo does not come through as an attachment. This varies from mail program to mail program, so it is best to consult your IT professional and test thoroughly to ensure it's working correctly.